ENGLISH C2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Advanced coordination

Coordinate clauses and phrases with shared material, correlative patterns and deliberate asymmetry while preserving scope and parallel status. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use advanced coordination to link units of equal discourse status without obscuring which elements are shared or contrasted while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Coordinate clauses and phrases with shared material, correlative patterns and deliberate asymmetry while preserving scope and parallel status.

MODEL

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

coordinate 1 + coordinator + coordinate 2 with controlled sharing

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main advanced coordination patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses link units of equal discourse status without obscuring which elements are shared or contrasted.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in formal argument, literary prose and complex professional writing.

Build meaning before form

Coordinate clauses and phrases with shared material, correlative patterns and deliberate asymmetry while preserving scope and parallel status.

What advanced coordination communicates

Coordinate clauses and phrases with shared material, correlative patterns and deliberate asymmetry while preserving scope and parallel status.

The central purpose is to link units of equal discourse status without obscuring which elements are shared or contrasted. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.	two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb
The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.	parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate
The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.	two alternatives placed under one negative scope

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: coordinate 1 + coordinator + coordinate 2 with controlled sharing. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Shared complement	verb/adjective shared across coordinates	The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.
Gapping	first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted	The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.
Correlative scope	either X or Y / neither X nor Y	The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb	Shared complement
parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate	Gapping
two alternatives placed under one negative scope	Correlative scope

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in formal argument, literary prose and complex professional writing. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
coordinate 1	coordinator	coordinate 2 with controlled sharing

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: link units of equal discourse status without obscuring which elements are shared or contrasted.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits formal argument, literary prose and complex professional writing.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Shared complement	verb/adjective shared across coordinates	The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.
Gapping	first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted	The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.
Correlative scope	either X or Y / neither X nor Y	The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.	two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb
The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.	parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate
The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.	two alternatives placed under one negative scope

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not coordinate constituents that do not occupy comparable grammatical roles.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Use punctuation and strict parallelism to make the gap recoverable.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Keep both correlative coordinates grammatically parallel.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb?

OPTIONS The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend. · The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one. · The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate?

OPTIONS The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one. · The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision. · The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: two alternatives placed under one negative scope?

OPTIONS The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision. · The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend. · The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb · parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate · two alternatives placed under one negative scope

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate · two alternatives placed under one negative scope · two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS two alternatives placed under one negative scope · two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb · parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Shared complement / Gapping / Correlative scope · Gap 2: two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb / parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate / two alternatives placed under one negative scope

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Gapping / Correlative scope / Shared complement · Gap 2: parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate / two alternatives placed under one negative scope / two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Correlative scope / Shared complement / Gapping · Gap 2: two alternatives placed under one negative scope / two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb / parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb: _____. Choose the model that expresses parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate: _____. Choose the model that expresses two alternatives placed under one negative scope: _____. Choose the model built with verb/adjective shared across coordinates: _____. Choose the model built with first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted: _____. Choose the model built with either X or Y / neither X nor Y: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision. · The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend. · The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The measure is _____ to defend. The northern region gained three seats; _____. The evidence supports _____ its later revision. State the full structural pattern for Shared complement: _____. State the full structural pattern for Gapping: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The measure is attractive politically but difficult economically.” using the Shared complement pattern to express two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The north gained three seats and the south gained one.” using the Gapping pattern to express parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The evidence supports neither version.” using the Correlative scope pattern to express two alternatives placed under one negative scope.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The measure is attractive politically but difficult economically.” using the Shared complement pattern to express two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Shared complement to express two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Gapping to express parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Correlative scope to express two alternatives placed under one negative scope, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

Shared complement is the best match because two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb.

A2

The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.

Gapping is the best match because parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate.

A3

The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

Correlative scope is the best match because two alternatives placed under one negative scope.

A4

two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb

The Shared complement pattern communicates two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb.

A5

parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate

The Gapping pattern communicates parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate.

A6

two alternatives placed under one negative scope

The Correlative scope pattern communicates two alternatives placed under one negative scope.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Shared complement / two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb

The structure belongs to the Shared complement pattern. Its communicative purpose is two evaluations sharing one subject and linking verb.

B2

Gapping / parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate

The structure belongs to the Gapping pattern. Its communicative purpose is parallel contrast with a recoverable omitted predicate.

B3

Correlative scope / two alternatives placed under one negative scope

The structure belongs to the Correlative scope pattern. Its communicative purpose is two alternatives placed under one negative scope.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

Shared complement: verb/adjective shared across coordinates.

C2

The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.

Gapping: first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted.

C3

The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

Correlative scope: either X or Y / neither X nor Y.

C4

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

Shared complement: verb/adjective shared across coordinates.

C5

The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.

Gapping: first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted.

C6

The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

Correlative scope: either X or Y / neither X nor Y.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

politically attractive but economically difficult

Shared complement requires “politically attractive but economically difficult” in this model. verb/adjective shared across coordinates.

D2

the southern region, only one

Gapping requires “the southern region, only one” in this model. first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted.

D3

neither the original claim nor

Correlative scope requires “neither the original claim nor” in this model. either X or Y / neither X nor Y.

D4

verb/adjective shared across coordinates

Shared complement is built as verb/adjective shared across coordinates.

D5

first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted

Gapping is built as first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

verb/adjective shared across coordinates. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended shared complement effect.

E2

The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one.

first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended gapping effect.

E3

The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision.

either X or Y / neither X nor Y. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended correlative scope effect.

E4

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend.

verb/adjective shared across coordinates. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended shared complement effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The measure is politically attractive but economically difficult to defend. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses verb/adjective shared across coordinates accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The northern region gained three seats; the southern region, only one. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses first clause full; second clause with shared verb omitted accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The evidence supports neither the original claim nor its later revision. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses either X or Y / neither X nor Y accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____